

Knock Knock

By

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1 EXT. FRONT GARDEN - DAY

A suburban street, quiet and empty.

A car door closes and BELLA (20 something , student) emerges from the car.

She stares at the bungalow, pleased with herself, then removes a filled cardboard box from the passenger seat of the car, struggling along the footpath towards the bungalow.

2 INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY

Bella collapses on the sofa with a cup of tea. She is accompanied by a couple of cardboard boxes.

She spots a soft toy in one of the boxes.

She lifts the toy from the box, it brings a smile to her face.

BELLA
Well Barney, we made it.

She places Barney beside her on the sofa, then looks at all the boxes.

BELLA
(Sighs) Right, lets get started.

BELLA stands up to stretch accidentally causing a box to topple over and knock into a standing lamp, this lamp then knocks into the wall.

BELLA sets the lamp back up and lifts the box to go unpack when suddenly she hears a knock on the other side of the wall. BELLA turns around and examines the wall with confusion, jokingly she places the box down on the sofa and knocks back, a few seconds pass and she hears one back, amused, BELLA knocks a second time and anticipates a response, but nothing happens. Assuming it was kids she happily shakes her head, picks up the box and continues on.

Montage of moving into the house.

- Bella lifts electrical cables from a box and begins untangling.

- Bella deciding on paint colours, screws up her face as she doesn't like the colour options.

- Bella still struggling with the wires

- Bella painting walls

(CONTINUED)

- Bella still untangling cables, gives up and throws them back in the box.

- the boxes disappearing as she unpacks them.

3 INT. BATHROOM - NIGHT

Bella stands at the sink in pajamas brushing her teeth.

She notices what appears to be dirt on her hands and begins to wash them, she does so for a moment but notices it hasn't come off, she applies more soap and scrubs them harder which has no effect.

Tired and slightly frustrated, she decides to just go to bed.

4 INT. HALLWAY - NIGHT

BELLA makes her way down the hallway towards the bedroom, when she reaches it and peers in to see the bed covered in boxes her demeanour deflates.

BELLA
I am not dealing with that
tonight...

She proceeds to take a pillow and blanket from the hall cupboard and heads into the living room.

5 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

BELLA is lying on the sofa under her blanket with a pillow and Barney watching a horror film. After a few moments the knocking starts, startling BELLA and causing her to jump up off the sofa. She stares angrily and worryingly at the wall.

BELLA
(Yelling) Give it a rest!

The knocking stops, and silence persists for a moment, BELLA snaps out of her fear and anger, switches off the television, and gets back under her blanket to get to sleep.

6 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Faint knocks slowly start to build, gaining in volume and clarity just as BELLA starts to wake and come into focus. BELLA jolts awake to a panic and jumps out of bed staring fearfully at the wall.

BELLA
(Quietly) What the fuck?

The knocking continues, making BELLA even more anxious.

(CONTINUED)

BELLA
(Shouting) What is your problem?

As soon as she shouts, footsteps can be heard rapidly leaving the other side of the wall, BELLA's anger changes to confusions and slight fear as she waits to see if the neighbor has quit, BELLA sighs from fatigue and relief and is about to go back to bed before casually looking across to the window only to see CREATURE staring in at her.

BELLA gasps in shock, and slowly approaches the window with a terrified expression.

Loud footsteps indicate the CREATURE has run from away from the window.

7 INT. HALLWAY - NIGHT

BELLA frantically opens the hall cupboard again, taking out her hockey stick.

Slowly and cautiously she starts to move up the hallway towards the front door, clutching the Hockey Stick.

BELLA unlocks the front door, takes a deep breath and prepares to go out, she bursts out the door quickly as if to startle anything out there.

8 EXT. FRONT GARDEN - NIGHT

BELLA in a mixture of anger and fear, frantically looks round to confront the CREATURE, but the street is empty. Just as she is starting to relax and think it was just her imagination, fast footsteps are heard scuttling around the side of the neighbor's house causing BELLA to jump and snap into defensive mode.

She crosses along the front of the two houses raising her hockey stick when reaching the corner of the neighbor's house, nothing is there, she heads back but stops as she notices the neighbor's front door being open.

With a terrified expression BELLA turns her head to peer into the dark hallway, she takes a minute to build up the courage, raises her stick, and proceeds to enter.

9 INT. NEIGHBOR'S HALLWAY - NIGHT

As BELLA creeps down the hallway she immediately notices how identical the place is to her own house.

She enters the neighbors living room that is opposite to her living room wall.

10 INT. NEIGHBOR'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

BELLA notices that the wall opposite to her living room wall that the knocks come from is beaten, blackened and dilapidated.

As BELLA goes to examine the wall, unbeknown to her, the CREATURE is standing in the doorway she just came from, a creek can be heard at the door causing BELLA to quickly glance to her side, nothing is there. She watches the door frame anxiously for a few seconds before turning back to the wall, as soon as she does a face melds through the wall causing BELLA to jump and stumble backwards and fall. As soon as she hits the ground she wakes up on the sofa.

11 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Before BELLA has time to comprehend that it was all a dream, the knocks she was hearing in said dream can be heard again as if she had woken up the same way she just had in her dream.

She quickly stands up, the realization can be seen in her face that her life is now mimicking her dream she just awoken from.

BELLA
(Fed up) Oh fuck off...

She looks around for a brief second, grabs her headphones, puts them on, grabs Barney and gets back into bed.

12 EXT. NEIGHBORHOOD - MORNING

The neighborhood is quite, not a person, car or sound in sight.

13 INT. LIVING ROOM - MORNING

BELLA is woken by her phone alarm, sitting up she looks around her to make sure everything is normal, she sighs in humorous disbelief and gets up to start her day.

14 INT. BATHROOM - MORNING

While BELLA is brushing her teeth, her attention is captured by her hands again, the dark, dirt-like substance looks worse than it did before.

Bella, Grossed out. Uses a lot of soap and furiously scrubs at her hands to remove the substance but still to no avail, frustrating BELLA.

15 INT. KITCHEN - MORNING

BELLA, standing at the counter top making a coffee, carries it to the table and calmly begins drinking it, she goes to take another sip when she hears a knock coming from her living room wall, she looks out into the hallway in fear, but that fear quickly turns to a stern expression.

BELLA
That's it, this is driving me up
the walls.

She sets her coffee down and storms up the hallway to the front door.

16 EXT. FRONT GARDEN - MORNING

BELLA exists the house and walks across to the neighbor's front door and starts furiously knocking on it, no answer.

BELLA
(Sternly) I know someone's home!

After knocking for a few seconds more she takes a step back frustrated. She glances around and makes eye contact with the door handle, we see BELLA having an internal debate on whether she should try the door, she looks around to see if anyone would see her then steps up to the door and tries the handle.

To her surprise the door opens, she gently pushes it fully open only to see the dark hallway she had dreamed about, she looks a nervous but takes one last look around her before entering the house.

17 INT. NEIGHBOR'S HALLWAY - MORNING

She creeps along the hallway looking more uneasy the further she travels as she realizes this is exactly how she imagined the house in her dream.

18 INT. NEIGHBOR'S LIVING ROOM - MORNING

She enters the living room that the knocks are coming from and notices the wall is just as blackened and beaten as it was in her dream.

BELLA
(Shocked) Oh you are fucking
kidding

BELLA backs back out into the hallway.

19 INT. NEIGHBOR'S HALLWAY - MORNING

A panicked BELLA rushes back up the hallway towards the front door, the CREATURE is seen further up the hallway unbeknown to her.

However the front door is now locked, BELLA frantically tries to open it as the CREATURE appears at the bottom of the hallway. After a few seconds of trying to open the door BELLA realizes she is being watched, she quickly turns around to face the threat but nothing is there, so she turns back to the door and begins trying to open it again when fast paced footsteps can be heard coming up the hallway.

BELLA quickly turns around and we see the CREATURE coming with it's hand outstretched.

20 EXT. NEIGHBOR'S HOUSE/BELLA'S HOUSE - MORNING

The outside of the neighbor's house is seen, it looks relatively normal, however we move across to BELLA'S house as we see her dressed in her clothes from the previous day, carrying boxes into her house.

21 INT. NEIGHBOR'S HALLWAY - DAY

BELLA wakes up on the floor of the neighbor's hallway, shes dazed and unable to see clearly, her hands and now parts of her face are exhibiting much more of the dark substance from earlier, she looks around confused and scared before rising to her feet. She tries the door one last time but it's still locked, still dazed, she shuffles back down the hallway into the neighbor's living room.

22 INT. NEIGHBOR'S LIVING ROOM - DAY

Seeing that nothing has changed she turns to leave before hearing a knock coming from her side of the wall.

This quickly shocks BELLA out of her dazed state as now she realizes something or someone is in her house, looking shocked, angry and terrified all at once she slowly approaches the wall and examines it for a moment before raising her hand to knock back.

She hesitates, but knocks back.

23 INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY

Exactly like the previous day, we see BELLA carrying a box away from the sofa, but turning when she hears a knock after the lamp falls into the wall, she smiles.

THE END